OTT TITANS · RIDDLE VAULT

TWELVE COINS, ONE FAKE

FIND IT IN THREE WEIGHINGS

THE CASE IN ONE LINE

One coin is lying about its weight. The scale may speak only three times.

CASE 03 · ONE RIDDLE · ONE ANSWER · NO SHORTCUTS

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THE CASE

Twelve coins lie on the table, identical to the eye. Eleven are honest. One is fake — a little heavier or a little lighter than the rest, and you do not know which way it lies.

Beside the coins stands a balance scale: two pans, no numbers, just a verdict — left down, right down, or level.

You may use the scale exactly three times. Not four. Three. And by the end you must point at the fake and declare, correctly, whether it is heavy or light.

THE QUESTION

Can you guarantee to find the fake coin — and its direction — in only three weighings?

THREE HINTS

Open them one at a time. Stop the moment you have it — the last hint nearly gives it away.

HINT 1
Do not hunt the coin. Hunt information: every weighing has three possible outcomes, and three weighings give you enough outcomes to cover twelve coins.

HINT 2
Split the coins into three groups, not two. What sits off the scale knows things too.

HINT 3
After the first tip, label every coin honestly: maybe-heavy, maybe-light, or proven genuine. Never let the labels blur.

YOUR MOVE

Can you guarantee to find the fake coin – and its direction – in only three weighings?

Decide your answer now — say it out loud or write it in the comments — before you turn this page. No going back.

THE REVEAL

THE ANSWER

Yes — three groups of four, and ruthless bookkeeping, guarantee the fake and its direction.

Weigh 4 against 4 (weighing 1). If it balances, the fake is in the 4 set aside and the 8 weighed are genuine. Weigh 3 suspects against 3 genuine coins (weighing 2): if it balances, the last suspect is fake — weigh it against a genuine coin to learn heavy or light. If it tips, the fake is among those 3 suspects and the tip's direction tells you heavy-or-light; weighing two of them against each other (weighing 3) finds it.

If the first weighing tips — say the left pan drops — the fake is a heavy coin from the left pan or a light coin from the right, and the 4 unweighed coins are genuine. For weighing 2, load 2 maybe-heavy + 1 maybe-light against 1 maybe-heavy + 1 maybe-light + 1 genuine. Each outcome — left, right, or level — shrinks the field to at most 3 suspects whose direction is now known, and weighing 3 finishes the job. The mirror case (right pan drops first) works the same way.

WHY IT WORKS

Three weighings, three outcomes each: 3 × 3 × 3 = 27 possible result-strings. Twelve coins, each possibly heavy or light, make 24 cases to distinguish — 24 fits inside 27, so a solution must exist; the scheme above is one that works.

The real skill is not the scale — it is the labels. Every weighing is designed so that each outcome eliminates the same share of suspects. That balance is what makes three weighings enough.

THE TRAP, NAMED

Greedy weighing — piling coins on to 'test more at once' — wastes outcomes. Information, counted coldly, beats effort.

MAKE THE VIDEO

This book is a production pack. The route from page to posted video:

1 · OPEN THE BOOK
The story, the question and the reveal in this book are your script beats, in order.

2 · GIVE IT TO THE AGENT
Paste the case into your AI agent (run it on Google Antigravity) and let it plan the shots from the beats.

3 · CONNECT GOOGLE FLOW
The agent builds the scenes as short clips in Flow. Keep the question on screen until the final seconds — the reveal is the last beat, never the first.

4 · EDIT + POST
Post with the question as the caption's first line and pin a comment asking for answers BEFORE the reveal. The debate in the comments is the engine.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

RIDDLE VAULT is the OTT Titans series of one-riddle books: one case per book, a verified answer, and the production route to turn it into a video. Every answer in this series is solved and checked before the book is made — if the logic has a hole, the riddle does not ship.

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More cases are waiting in the Vault — and a new riddle video lands every day on the 1 Minute Detective channels.

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